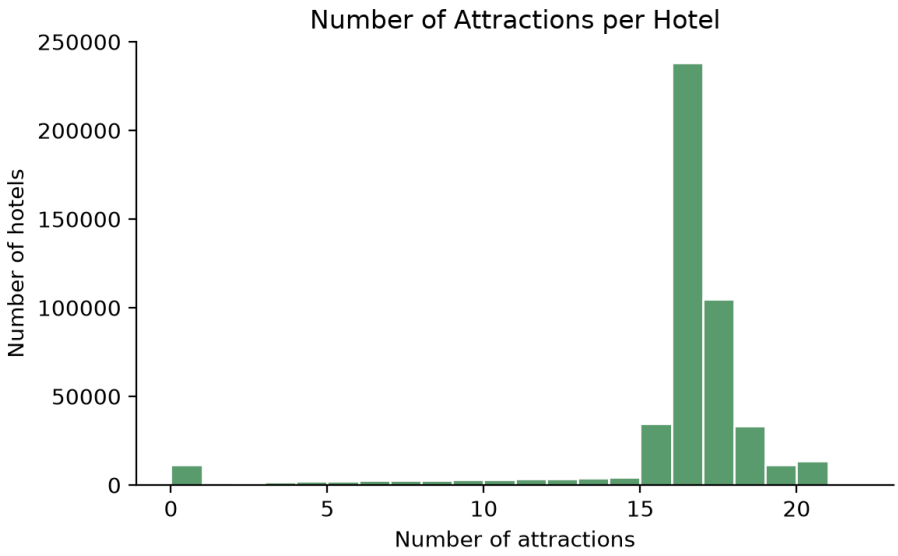
Deliverable 1 - Data

By Dinidu Samaranayake and Oliver Hankins

For our project, we collected data on hotels and other places people might visit, with a focus on their reviews and where they are. We pulled from a few academic and public datasets.

Google Local Data (UCSD McAuley Lab): This is our primary source, containing Google Maps reviews and metadata (names, addresses, GPS coordinates, category tags, descriptions, ratings, and price tiers) from the Google Local and McAuley Lab datasets. The data contains over 170,000 businesses and has a median text length of 11 words, so aggregation would be useful and save memory. It is also skewed towards 5-star reviews, something to take into account.

TBO Hotels (Kaggle): This is a worldwide dataset of over 1 million hotels from Kaggle providing hotel locations, descriptions, star ratings, facilities, and nearby attractions (excluding guest reviews and pricing). Considering that this is for vacation planning specifically, we focused on looking at nearby attractions and general vibes. Looking at the distribution, we see most hotels have generally 15-18 attractions, which we should prioritize and score higher when the algorithm is made.



Traveler Trip Data (Kaggle): This is a synthetic trip dataset from Kaggle covering destinations, trip durations, and estimated lodging/transportation costs, used strictly as a baseline for typical expense ranges. In terms of the system, it'll be mostly used to determine cost, which the data is insightful at showing.

